

Tuan (Todd) Cao

PhD in Management (Marketing)

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Summary

With 4 years of experience as a lecturer and 7 years in education, I translate theory into practice through field trips, workshops, and expert-led sessions. As a Program Director, I oversee program quality by embedding industry engagement through two structured internships and student competitions. My research focuses on the intersection of artificial intelligence and psychographics across influencer marketing, organizational behavior, tourism, and sustainability. I hold a PhD in Management (Marketing) from the University of Southern Queensland, Australia, and will soon hold a second PhD in Management from Ho Chi Minh City Open University, Vietnam.

Education

PhD	University of Southern Queensland, Australia , Management (Marketing)	Completed in April 2026
	- The thesis examines how consumer well-being is shaped by unfulfilled aspirations and obligations, and how consumers use compensatory consumption to cope with these tensions. - Integrating a systematic review, experimental studies, and conceptual modeling, the thesis shows that compensatory consumption is a context dependent coping mechanism that varies across financial strain, religious conflict, and gambling behavior. - The thesis aims to identify how consumers may be better protected from manipulative marketing practices.	
PhD	Open University, Vietnam , Management (Marketing)	Expected completion in June 2026
	- The thesis examines how Artificial Intelligence can be evaluated more fairly as a human-like social actor. - Integrating PLS-SEM, machine-learning analyses, and in-depth interviews, the thesis shows that AI agents can serve as effective counsellors and endorsers to support well-being, engagement, and decision-making in organizational and tourism contexts. - The thesis focuses on how ethical perception, trust, and sustainability shape human responses to AI in emerging service interactions.	
Master	Open University, Vietnam , MBA	2017 - 2019
	- The thesis examines how athletic endorsers influence consumer responses to non-sport product endorsements. - I graduated as Valedictorian, ranking first in both the entrance examination and final graduation cohort (Entrance Exam: 9.44 GPA: 8.44 Thesis Defense: 9.8).	
BAcct	Hung Vuong University , Accounting	2011 - 2015

Experience

Hoa Sen University , Program Director	Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam 2026 - present
- Lead quality assurance aligned with ASIIN, AUN-QA, FIBAA, and NEAS standards - Manage faculty coordination, teaching allocation, and student progression - Build industry partnerships to enhance internships and employability	
Griffith University , Seasonal Academic	Brisbane, Australia 2025 - present
Conducted literature reviews, data collection, survey programming, and data analysis for research projects.	

- Prepared ethics documents, manuscripts, and journal revision materials for academic publication.
- Coordinated tutorial materials, project timelines, and academic communication across research activities.

Hoa Sen University, Lecturer

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2026 - present

- Taught Introduction to Public Relations - PR202DE01
- Taught Crisis Management - PR402DE01
- Taught Fundamentals of Business and Management - PR201DE02
- Taught Media Audience Research - TT301DE02

Van Lang University, Lecturer

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2023 - 2024

- Taught Basic Marketing - 71MRKT30013
- Taught Consumer Behavior - 71MRKT40073
- Taught Business Analytics - 71BUSI30053

Rouen University (France) - Vietnam Campus, Lecturer

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2021

- Taught Introduction Marketing

Nguyen Tat Thanh University, Lecturer

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2020 – 2023

- Taught E-Commerce
- Taught Strategic Marketing
- Introduction to International Business

IMAP Corporation, Academic Trainer and Teacher

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2018 – 2024

- Trained 30+ teachers
- Taught 5,000+ students
- Mentored 200+ students to IELTS 7.0+

NIS International School, Brand Manager

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2017 – 2020

- Managed campus operations and cross-functional teams
- Increased enrollment by 10%
- Led brand communication strategy
- Built community and media partnerships

Greenwich University (UK) – Vietnam Campus, Marketing Executive

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2017

- Conducted high school outreach across Ho Chi Minh City
- Organized recruitment events and campus activations
- Converted prospects through personalized consultation

Freelance, Event Organizer

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2014 – 2016

- Organized Investment Day for Fich Clinic
- Directed stage play “Wukong Re-Spring” with 30+ actors (\$5,000 award)
- Coordinated charity tours (50 participants)
- Executed events for Cali School (210+ attendees)
- Managed cultural events for Leaf Pagoda (70+ attendees each)
- Designed competition game “The Amazing Race” (24 participants)

Freelance, Marketing Executive

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2012 – 2015

- Organized promotional events at Lucuffee
- Coordinated international teams
- Promoted cocktail and wine offerings

- Developed content for beauty vlogger Goc Cua Ru

Youth Learning Center, Founder (Yumetalk)

- Founded an English and cultural exchange program
- Designed workshops on communication and public speaking
- Built and managed a team of 10+ volunteers
- Organized community events (100+ participants)

Ho Chi Minh, Vietnam
2011 – 2013

Academic work

Cao, T. T.* , Prentice, C., Wang, Q., & Nguyen, S. (2025). Financial self-discrepancy, consumer well-being, and luxury preferences: The moderating effect of access-based luxury formats. <i>Psychology & Marketing</i> , 43, 357-373. https://doi.org/10.1002/mar.70057	Published, Q1, A-ranked ABDC, IF 9.1
Cao, T. T. , Prentice, C., Wang, Q., & Nguyen, H. S*. (2026). Conflicted by faith, drawn to pleasure: How religious self-discrepancy shapes product choices. <i>International Journal of Consumer Studies</i> , 50(2), e70202. https://doi.org/10.1111/ijcs.70202	Published, Q1, A-ranked ABDC, IF 7.7
Cao, T. T.* , Prentice, C., Wang, Q., & Nguyen, H. S. (2025). Compensatory consumption: A review and research agenda using the theory-context-characteristics-methodology framework. <i>International Journal of Consumer Studies</i> , 49(5), e701112. https://doi.org/10.1111/ijcs.70112	Published, Q1, A-ranked ABDC, IF 7.7
Cao, T. T.* (2025). Self-discrepancy and gambling retention: A conceptual model of motivational and moral pathways. <i>Strategic Business Research</i> , 1(1), 100001. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.sbr.2025.100001	Published, peer-reviewed journal
Cao, T. T. , & Nguyen, S.* (2024). Navigating dual identities: How bicultural consumers leverage luxury consumption to cope with perceived discrimination and enhance well-being. <i>Journal of Development and Integration</i> , 85, 106-116. https://doi.org/10.61602/jdi.2025.85.12	Published, peer-reviewed journal
Ha, N. M., & Cao, T. T.* (2019). Constructing athlete identification and the effectiveness of athlete endorsement on customer's purchase intention. <i>Journal of Distribution Science</i> , 17(8). https://doi.org/10.15722/jds.17.8.201908.87	Published, peer-reviewed journal
Mai, N., Cao, T. , & Yunen, Z. (2025). How hotels communicate sustainability goal revisions: The role of perceived green-rinsing, influencer type, and sustainability solutions. <i>Journal of Sustainable Tourism</i> .	First Revision, Q1 JCR, A*-ranked ABDC, IF 9.9
Cao, T. T. , Yunen, Z., & Tuan, N.* (2026). When Generative Artificial Intelligence becomes a counsellor: How employee evaluations shape engagement and organizational attractiveness. <i>Journal of Enterprise Information Management</i> .	Second Revision, Q1, A-ranked ABDC, IF 7.6
Cao, T. T. , & Tuan, N.* (2026). Understanding consumer purchase intention toward Zero-Click GenAI-generated recommendations: Evidence from structural equation modeling and machine learning. <i>Journal of Internet Commerce</i> .	Second Revision, Q1, B-ranked ABDC, IF 4.3
Cao, T. T. , Mai, N., Tuan, N.*, Malik, A., & Anjali, T. (2026). How employees evaluate Artificial Intelligence-generated leaders: Perceived responsibility, ethicality, and authenticity as pathways to compliance. <i>The Service Industries Journal</i> .	First Revision, Q1, A-ranked ABDC, IF 7.4
Tuan, N., & Cao, T. T.* (2026). Working with GenAI: How human-centered mindset and GenAI understanding drive employee autonomy and competence. <i>Journal of Enterprise Information Management</i> .	Submission, Q1, A-ranked ABDC, IF 7.6
Mai, N., Cao, T. , Yunen, Z. & Tingwen X. (2025). Deepfake versus Virtual Influencers: How Influencer Diversity and Corporate Social Responsibility Shape Consumer Ethicality and Engagement <i>Journal of Business Ethics</i> .	Under Review, Q1, A-ranked ABDC, IF 8.7
Yunen, Z., Mai, N., & Cao, T. T.* , (2026). When synthetic endorsers are morally acceptable: Context-dependent consumer responses to AI-generated synthetic endorsers. <i>Jour-</i>	Submission, Q1, A-ranked ABDC, IF 8.7

nal of Business Ethics.

Cao, T. T., Mai, N., & Yunen, Z.* (2026). Deepfake versus human influencers in hospitality marketing: the roles of emotional exhaustion, autonomy, and identity similarity in shaping booking intention. *Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management.*

Submission, Q1,
A*-ranked ABDC, IF 8.7

Yunen, Z., **Cao, T.,** & Mai, N.* (2025). The right endorser for the right stay: How human and AI endorsers differ across privacy levels and service modes in accommodation booking intention. *Journal of Travel Research.*

Under Review, Q1,
A*-ranked ABDC, IF 9.8

Nguyen, M., **Cao, T. T.,** Yunen, Z.*, & Yang, B. (2026). From Virtual Endorsers to Booking Intention: Understanding Consumer Responses to AI-Generated Lodging Advertising. *Tourism Management.*

Submission, Q1,
A*-ranked ABDC, IF 9.9

Cao, T. T., Mai, N., & Yunen, Z. (2025). How deepfake influencers shape hotel booking decisions. *Journal of Travel Research* .

Submission, Q1 JCR,
A*-ranked ABDC, IF 9.8

Huong, P., Thinh, D., & **Cao, T. T.*** (2025). Revaluating waste: The roles of true-to-ideal authenticity, actual-ought discrepancy, and user-generated content in willingness to pay for upcycled food. *International Journal of Consumer Studies.*

Submission, Q1 JCR,
A-ranked ABDC, IF 7.7

Awards

University Representative for Accreditation	2021
Dedicated Teacher Award	2021
Best Teacher of the Year	2020
University Representative for FIBAA Accreditation	2020
Valedictorian, Master's Program	2019
Highest GPA, Master's Program	2019
Highest Thesis Defense Score, Master's Program	2019
First Place, Master's Entrance Examination	2017

Scholarships and Funding

PhD full scholarship and stipend, University of Southern Queensland, Australia (\$123k)	2024 – 2026
Research grant, Ministry of Education and Training (B2024-MBS-09)	(\$20k) 2024
Master's full scholarship, Open University Vietnam	(\$6k) 2017 – 2019

Skills

Languages: Vietnamese (native), English (IELTS 8.0)

Research & Analytical Skills: Experimental and quasi-experimental design, cross-sectional research, systematic literature review, machine learning (Elastic Net, Random Forest)

Software & Tools: R (RStudio), SPSS, PLS-SEM, Quarto, GitHub, LaTeX

Peer-review experience

Tourism

Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management

Marketing

Psychology & Marketing

International Journal of Consumer Studies

Strategic Business Research

Management

Journal of Internet Commerce

Journal of Enterprise Information Management

Reference

Prof. Dr. Catherine Prentice

Head of the Marketing Discipline at the University of Southern Queensland, Australia

Catherine.Prentice@unisq.edu.au

Dr. Jenny (Qingxia) Wang

Senior Lecturer at the University of Southern Queensland, Australia

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Dr. Mai Nguyen

Senior Lecturer at Griffith University, Australia

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